

Bread

First eaten around 30,000 years ago, bread is a favourite food all around the world. Usually made with wheat or rye flour, it is easy to make and a great source of carbohydrates for energy. There are thousands of delicious varieties of bread, from flat and crisp to plaited and fluffy.

MAKING BREAD

Making bread is not difficult, although you need some strength to knead the dough and patience while it proves (rises). These steps show how to make a simple white loaf.



1 FLOUR
Sift plain flour and salt into a bowl.



2 Add a mixture of water, milk, and yeast. Combine everything together until they form a dough.



3 Place the dough on a floured board. Let it rest for a few minutes. Then knead it for 5–10 minutes.

ROLLS

Rolls, and other forms of bread, come in all shapes and sizes. Many, such as bagels, have become popular all over the world.



WHOLEMEAL ROLL
UK



PICOS ROLLS
Spain



SKILLET BREAD
USA



PIRAGI
Latvia

WHO EATS THE MOST BREAD?

These ten countries eat more bread per person per year than anywhere else in the world.

- 1 TURKEY**
104.6 kg (230.5 lb) per person per year. Favourites: bazlama, gözleme, and pide.
- 2 CHILE**
96 kg (211.5 lb) per person per year. Favourites: marraqueta, hallulla, and coliza.
- 3 ARGENTINA**
76 kg (167.5 lb) per person per year. Favourites: pan de campo, pan de chapa, and chipas.
- 4 DENMARK**
70 kg (154 lb) per person per year. Favourites: rye and pumpernickel.
- 4 GREECE**
70 kg (154 lb) per person per year. Favourites: daktyla, lagana, and pitta.
- 4 POLAND**
70 kg (154 lb) per person per year. Favourites: rye, wholegrain, flavoured breads, and bagels.
- 5 IRELAND**
68 kg (150 lb) per person per year. Favourites: potato, soda, and barmbrack.
- 6 HUNGARY**
60 kg (132 lb) per person per year. Favourites: lángos, pogácsa, and pretzels.
- 6 THE NETHERLANDS**
60 kg (132 lb) per person per year. Favourites: wholegrain, rye, and suikerbrood.
- 7 GERMANY**
57 kg (125.5 lb) per person per year. Favourites: rye, wholegrain, and wheat-rye.



LEAVENED BREAD

In leavened breads (where the dough rises), yeast or baking powder is added to the flour combined with a liquid like buttermilk to create carbon dioxide gas. This makes the bread light and airy. Thousands of different types of leavened bread are baked around the world.



PUMPERNICKEL
Germany



SEVEN GRAIN BREAD
USA



WHOLEMEAL COTTAGE LOAF
UK



BAGUETTE
France



ZOPF
Switzerland



CIABATTA
Italy



WHITE LOAF
UK



SOURDOUGH LOAF
Middle East



PANE DI PATATE
Italy



PARTYBROT
Germany



MANTOU STEAMED BREAD
China



HEFEZOPF
Germany



PAIN À L'ANCIENNE
France

RAISING AGENT

Many types of bread are leavened, meaning that they have had something added to them to make them rise. The most common rising agent is yeast, which comes in various forms.



FLATBREADS

Most flatbreads do not contain yeast, although some, such as pitta bread and naan bread, are slightly leavened. Pitta bread opens up to form a pocket that can be filled with different ingredients. Other flat breads can be used like a plate and then eaten.



PITTA BREAD
Middle East



PIDE
Turkey



NAAN
India



FLATBREAD
Italy



CRISPBREAD
Sweden



TORTILLA
Spain

FLAVOURS FOR BREAD

Bread can be mixed with lots of different ingredients to make it taste savoury or sweet. Savoury breads can be flavoured with strong tastes, like onion and cheese. Sweet-flavoured breads often have fruit, nuts, and spices added to them.

GERMANY HAS MORE THAN 1,300 VARIETIES OF BREAD, ROLLS, AND PASTRIES